SILLIMAN SWIM SCHOOL INSTRUCTOR MANUAL

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The Silliman Way - Philosophy and Teaching Principles

1. American Red Cross Water Safety and survival skills are our first priority.
2. Our goal is for all our swimmers to LOVE swimming for LIFE.
3. Knowledge of how to modify or teach using a different method. Understand that there are multiple ways to teach. Not all swimmers learn the same.
4. Unconditional respect. Teach and correct with love, empathy and compassion.
5. Clear communication and constructive feedback.
6. Repetition and patterns.
7. Enthusiasm, positivity, creativity and adventure.
8. Encourage perpetual motion and efficiency in the water.
9. Nurturing and individualized instruction with results.
10. Provide most up-to-date techniques and progression strategies.

Swimming Skills that are Paramount

1. **Relaxation in the water** – You must be relaxed to float and swim efficiently.
2. **Bubbles/Bobs** – Breath control encourages students to relax. Want to insure that we integrate this into our training at all levels.
3. **Back Floats** – Life saving skill. Want to integrate American Red Cross Safety Skills at all levels.
4. **Proper body position and head placement** – We want to promote proper body positioning (horizontal swimming) from their first lesson. Make sure that their head stays low with their eyes down, implement rollovers instead of "pop-ups to breathe". Feel free to use props or toys on bottom of pool so the kids get used to keeping their eyes down at the bottom of the pool. This progresses into more efficient swimming habits, preventing their body to drag through the water.
5. **Avoid "pop-ups" to breathe, focus on rotation** – Encourage horizontal, not vertical swimming. We want to try to promote proper body positioning from the beginning of their learning experience. When a student pops their head up to breathe, it makes it more difficult to move through the water as their hips sink.
6. **Rollovers** – Life saving skill. Want to integrate this safety skill at all levels and try to make this instinct.
7. **Side swimming (kicking on the side)** – Teach students how to float and kick on their side. This makes the transition easy when introducing side breathing, rotation, and other long axis swimming fundamentals.
8. **Ready Positions and Streamlines** – Introduce proper starts from the beginning. This will make an easy transition for our swimmers to progress to a swim team or Masters Swimming program (for adults).
9. **Kicking –** Kicking is the foundation to building an efficient technique. All swim lessons should have some focus on increasing kicking speed, endurance, and strength (with all 4 competitive strokes).

10. **Individuality** – As instructors, you are constantly learning from your peers and students! Be open to different approaches, learn from other instructors. Note that not every individual learns the same. Some students may be visual learners, while others need a more hands on approach. Mix up your style of teaching and accommodate their students based on their learning strategies. Never stop improving your skills, but follow the basic guidelines. Most importantly, have fun!

Instructor Expectations and Characteristics

Safety

Safety will be your number one priority. Your back should never be turned to your students, regardless of their age and/or skill level. Some children do not tend to realize they have limitations in the water and will assume they can swim unassisted. You will constantly and consistently need to integrate water safety into your lesson plans and curriculum. When working with children, you should be close by in the case they may need your assistance. (NO going across the pool, leaving your kids alone on the stairs or wall. Your back should NEVER be turned to your students!)

Teamwork

We need all of our instructors to work as a team in order to maintain a successful program. Remember, "you're only as strong as your weakest link". Let's help each other improve and be great! Share tips and tricks with other instructors and offer suggestions and help if needed. Please be respectful of your co-workers and stay positive with your feedback! Help each other out with difficult kids and share space and equipment if needed.

Go Above and Beyond

Great instructors need patience, confidence and need to be self-motivated. You are not just a student's instructor; you are their friend, mentor, babysitter, lifeguard, coach and someone they will hopefully remember forever! You must find the perfect balance between fun and discipline. You must be energetic, happy to be here and 100% focused on your students every lesson. Reward and praise your swimmers when it is deserved.

Professionalism

You will be visible to patrons and members at our facility while you are teaching. Your focus and attention should be on your swimmers, not your fellow coworkers. Remember, swim lessons are a referral based business. The majority of our swim school swimmers find us through word of mouth.

Communication and Feedback

Please have an open line of communication with our Senior Guards/Instructors and Aquatics Coordinators. They are here to assist you! Do not hesitate to voice any concerns, comments, or ask us if you have any questions! Please take constructive advice with a positive attitude. Everyday should be a learning experience for you, as well as for your students.

Communication with Parents Every Lesson

Always greet or talk to the parents before and after teaching the child at least every class, not just on the last day. Be confident and portray your confidence when talking to parents. After each lesson, inform parents of the progress that their child has made, and communicate any issues or challenges if applicable. Make it personal so that the parents feel involved with their child's progression. You can also explain what skills they can practice at home to reinforce what the child is learning at the pool. Remember we want to establish a first name relationship with our swimmers and their families.

Be Consistent and Prepared

Parents and swim lesson pupils expect and deserve you to be on time. All swim instructors are expected and required to be consistent with their attendance. Always teach the full lesson and use the 5 minute break between your next lesson to communicate with the child's parent or guardian. Our goal is to ensure that the student is being instructed by the same instructor every lesson. If you absolutely need subs, keep them consistent! Please do not commit to a session if you cannot teach all lesson dates.

Enthusiasm

Be happy to see your students! They look forward to seeing you at the pool and it may even be the highlight of their day! Know their

names, and make an effort to get to know them (ask questions about their interests, how school is going, siblings, etc…). Create unique fun ways for the swimmers to learn while still having a good time. Swimming is fun! Remember, we want all of our swimmers to love swimming for life! Be enthusiastic and show your love for the kids and what you do. Don't be afraid to be goofy! Be silly, sing songs, play with the kids! Go underwater and have fun with your swimmers.

Knowledge

Stay up-to-date with the most teaching methodologies. Attend trainings to learn from your fellow instructors and receive additional tips and tricks to help you improve and expand your skill set!

Be Patient, But Firm

Every parent is looking for an instructor that portrays an even balance of fun and enthusiasm, but also expects their child to be challenged and disciplined when needed. If you are unsure of how to deal with a rowdy student, talk to the parent to find what disciplinary actions they are okay with (i.e. sitting on the wall, sitting next to the lifeguard, no playing games, etc.). You must also seek to learn what the parent's wishes are for their swimmer. Every child is different and has a different way of learning. Swimming is a tough skill to learn and progression takes time. Be patient!

Set-Up and Clean-Up & Pool Space

Keep the pool deck and equipment room clean and organized. Please make sure you are prepared with your instructor whiteboard and equipment prior to the lesson. At the end of lessons instructors are responsible for cleaning and putting away all their equipment as well. Work together as a team to set-up and clean-up.

Instructor Training Requirements

You will be required to shadow an experienced instructor during your training period.

In addition, all swim instructors must attend all swim instructor trainings on a regular basis. If you cannot attend a meeting, please inform your Aquatics Coordinator and/or the Senior Guard/Instructor in ADVANCE.

Remember your fellow instructors are always here to help you! We have instructors with over 10+ years of experience. Use them as a reference and learn from them! Don't be afraid to ask questions!

It is preferred that our instructors obtain an American Red Cross Lifeguarding certification (Lifeguard, First Aid, CPR, and AED training) within their course of employment. It is also preferred that our instructors have an American Red Cross Water Safety Instructor Certification (WSI). It is your responsibility to ensure that your certifications stay up-to-date!

Silliman Aquatics Program Listings By Age Group

Lesson Levels for 3 and under

Aqua Tot (Ages 6 months – 3 years) *this is an interactive class for parents and children
Preschool Swim Lessons *if the child is comfortable with an instructor (without parent)
Private Swim Lessons *if the child is comfortable with an instructor (without parent)
Semi-Private Swim Lessons *if the child is comfortable with an instructor (without parent)

Lesson Levels for Ages 3- 5

Preschool Level 1
Preschool Level 2
Preschool Level 3
Private Swim Lessons
Semi-Private Preschool Swim Lessons

Lesson Levels for Ages 6- 12

Competitive Swim Lessons *for ages 7 and up
Youth Level 1
Youth Level 2
Youth Level 3
Youth Level 4
Youth Level 5
Private Swim Lessons
Semi-Private Youth Swim Lessons

Lesson Levels for Ages 13 and up

Competitive Swim Lessons *ages 7-17
Adult/Teen Lessons

Silliman Swim School Level Descriptions

Aquatot Classes (6 months – 3 years)

Parent & tot to teacher ratio is 10:1 - Class time is 25 minutes weekdays and weekends

This interactive class is for parents and children. The instructor will lead the parents through a variety of skills to teach their child. The parent is the primary instructor for their child and is required to be in the water with the child in a swimsuit. Children must wear a swim diaper under their suit. The class is designed to get the child comfortable in the water and to begin to work on entry-level swim readiness skills. Upon successful completion or age advancement the student will move into the preschool lesson program.

Pre-School Swim Classes (3- 6 years)

Student to teacher ratio is 4:1 - Class time is 25 minutes weekdays, 40 minutes weekends

Level 1: This introductory class is for children who are new to swimming or nervous in the water. Our goal is to develop confidence, breath control and proper body position. Positive reinforcement is our main focus to help the child build trust and confidence. Graduates will be able to do 5 relaxed bobs, front float/back float for 5 seconds with support, jump to teacher from the wall and relax in an assisted back float.

Level 2: This class is for children who are comfortable in the pool and will go underwater willingly and happily. In this level the focus is on learning proper breathing techniques, improving floating skills, kicking strength and survival skills. Graduates will be able to do (unsupported) back floats and front floats comfortably, streamline with straight leg kicks, propulsive kicks on back, rollovers and front crawl.

Level 3: This level is for children who are able to swim independently and are ready to be introduced to some competitive strokes. In this advanced level, graduates will be able to swim freestyle with side breathing at least 5 times consistently, backstroke for 4 body lengths, rollovers, streamline glides for 2 body lengths, and elementary backstroke.

Youth Swim Classes (6 – 12 years)

Student teacher ratio is 6:1 – class time is 25 minutes weekdays, 40 minutes weekends

Level 1: The focus of this level is to build confidence and learn basic water safety skills through fun and games. Graduates will be able to do (supported) small fast kicks front and back for 2 body lengths, front floats with full face in the water, back floats with ears in the water, full head submersions at least 5 times, introduced to elementary backstroke, and comfortably perform alternating arms and leg action for 2 body lengths.

Level 2: This class focuses on introducing independent swimming to the swimmers. Graduates should be able to do (all unsupported) front and back floats, combined arm circles and kicks for 3 body lengths, kicks on back for 5 body lengths, and elementary back stroke.

Level 3: The goal of this class is to introduce and practice all competitive strokes and to prepare our swimmers for Lap pool. Emphasis will be placed on the basics of the competitive strokes such as dolphin kicks 3-5 body lengths, breaststroke kicks 5 body lengths, freestyle with side breathing at least 10 times, backstroke at least 4 body lengths, and elementary backstroke for 5 body lengths.

Level 4: This class focuses on building endurance and going more in depth on correcting their competitive strokes. Graduates will be able to do freestyle for 25 yards, backstroke for 25 yards, butterfly for 15 yards, breaststroke for 15 yards, elementary backstroke for 25 yards, and introduction to side strokes and open turns.

Level 5: The goal of this class is to prepare swimmers for competitive swim. Emphasis will be on refining techniques in all competitive strokes and introducing flip turns. Graduates will move onto competitive swim or be able to join a swim team. They will be able to perform a 50 yard freestyle with flip turn, 50 yards of backstroke with flip turn, 25 yards of butterfly, 25 yards of sidestroke, 25 yards of breaststroke, 25 yards of elementary backstroke, and be able to tread for at least 5 minutes

Competitive Swim Lessons (7-17 years)

Student to teacher ratio is 10:1 - Class time is 45 minutes

Competitive Swim Lessons: This course is designed for those who have completed the Youth Level 5, or age group swimmers who no longer have their swim team workouts. Class will focus on the 4 main competitive strokes in a structured swim workout environment. Classes will consist of drills meant to refine swimmers techniques, timing, and to keep up their endurance as well.

Private and Semi- Private Swim Classes (3-12 years)

Private Classes: 1 on 1 individualized instruction for those looking for a more personalized approach. These lessons are completely focused on working on what the swimmer or parent wants to work on. Ages vary from 3+, **Classes are 30 minutes long**

Semi-Private Classes: This course is taught like normal Youth/Preschool classes but with fewer students per instructor. Maximum is 2 students per instructor. And is to focus on what the student or parent want out of the lesson. Preschool is ages 3-5, Youth is ages 6-12. **Classes are 25 minutes long on weekdays and 40**

minutes on the weekend

Adult/Teen Classes (13+ years)

Student to teacher ratio is 6:1 – Class time is 40 minutes long

This course is designed to help adults/teens meet their swim lesson needs from beginner to advance and focusing on the individual needs of each student.

Conquering Your Fear of the Water *TENTATIVE FALL 2017 PROGRAM (TBA)

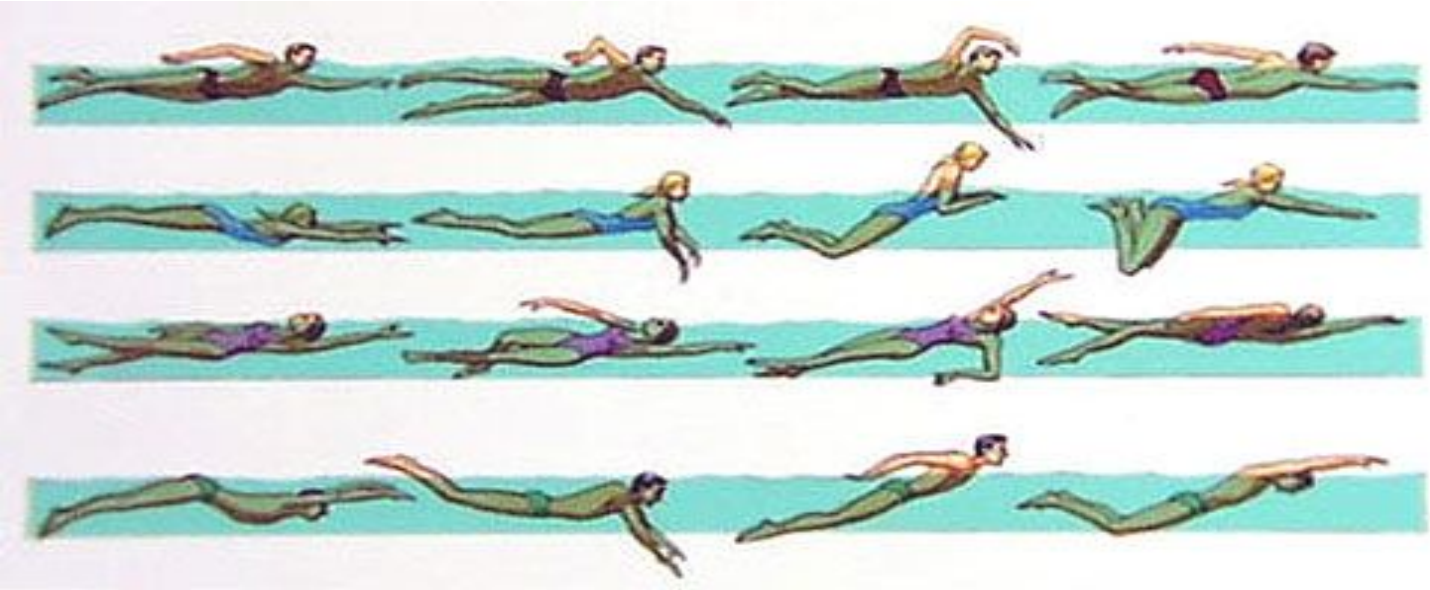
This class is designed to help adults who are learning to swim, or are uncomfortable in the water. We will progress at each individual's own pace in a supportive environment so as to experience one of the most relaxing, low-impact, types of exercise. We will help you have fun in the water by using rings, barbells, water polo balls, flippers and foam workout noodles. If you can learn to be comfortable in the water, you're one step closer to being a confident swimmer.

Swimming with Ease *TENTATIVE FALL 2017 PROGRAM (TBA)

This class is designed for those who are comfortable underwater but need help swimming laps efficiently. We will develop a solid foundation of swimming skills, focusing on technique and gracefulness. Freestyle will be the main focus with a lot concentration of proper breathing and balance in the water. Additionally, you'll be introduced to the other variety of swim strokes such as breaststroke, backstroke, elementary backstroke and sidestroke.

Swimming for Fitness *TENTATIVE FALL 2017 PROGRAM (TBA)

This class is intended to prepare you for a Masters Swimming program or general lap swimming. This class will focus on building your endurance through freestyle training. We will also practice the fundamentals of the other strokes: backstroke, breaststroke, and butterfly. We will also work on flip turns and treading water.



Teaching Infants and Toddlers to Swim

Aquatot (ages 6 mo - 3 years)
This interactive class is designed for little ones to become comfortable in and around the water. Emphasis is placed on teaching the parent the proper instruction techniques and general pool safety. Instead of

teaching the children directly, you are the facilitator off the parent-child interaction. By using songs, games and equipment we introduce: floating skills, breath control, gentle submersions, pool and water safety and survival skills.

Teaching an Aquatot class:

- The main difference between this class and other group class is that, instead of being the instructor, you are now the facilitator of parent-child interaction.
- In these lessons it is important to have effective communication with the parents.
- Please note that many parents are not as comfortable in the water as you are. They are nervous about putting their kids underwater. You know much more about swimming than they do, so don't be afraid to display your confidence.
- Your role is to guide, instruct, and provide corrective feedback to help the parents as their children explore the aquatic world.
- Remember to constantly explain why you're having the class sing this song or play that game. Parents want to know why and how it will help their child.
- Most importantly, let the parent know their child will not learn how to swim or be water safe in one session. Learning how to swim is a journey and takes time!
- Children are often affected by their parents' comfort in and out of the water. Remind parents that their behavior and mood often correlates to how the child is feeling. If parents maintain a positive attitude towards swimming, their children will be less likely to be afraid.

Skills to be taught in Aquatot classes:

- Water adjustment
- Exploring the pool
- Front kicks and floats
- Safe entry and exit
- Wall crawl
- Blowing bubbles (only kids 2 and up)
- Underwater exploration
- Back floats
- Basic arm movements
- Rollovers
- Swim to steps, dock, or wall

Basic Aquatot lesson plan:

5 min: Introduction song and review skills learned previously
5 min: Practice time for review skills - take a minute with each family
5 min: Song and introduce focus of the day
10 min: Practice time for new focus – spend a minute with each family
5 min: Goodbye and reminder of what was learned today

Focal Points of each lesson:

It's helpful to have a focus for each lesson. It's a great way for to keep track of what you have taught and it's also helpful for the parent who is new to swim classes.

Lesson #1 Proper holds (front and back)

- First, make sure parents stand low in the water with their shoulders submerged and the child level so that they are warm and eye-to-eye.
- Underarm hold, face to face: keep kids horizontal on the surface of the water, drifting their legs behind them; walking backwards helps; try to keep wrists close together so that the child rests more on the palms their your hands
- Basic back float: "cheek-to-cheek", the child's head is on the parent's shoulder, and the parent stays very close; encourage parent to sing or talk softly. Goal is to have child get comfortable having ears in the water. Parent should remain low in the water with shoulders submerged.
- "Football hold": place a hand horizontally on the child's chest and back

Lesson #2 Learn submersions

- This technique is perfect for the parent who is in the water without another adult. Before any submersion it is important to remember to use a verbal cue such as "1-2-3!" or "Ready, set, go!" so that the child is ready. First, have the adult stand in the water, holding the child so that they are facing the parent. Next, take two steps back, use your cue, and gently "swoop" the child under water. We want to explain that the kids should be submerged at an angle, as opposed to being "dunked" straight down towards the bottom. We want to try to avoid getting water shot up the child's nose (which is why we do this at an angle). Encourage parents to bring child close and to praise them. Remember to check for delayed apnea by sprinkling water on kids' faces.

Lesson #3 Front kicks and pool exploration

- Using the underarm hold, keep kids horizontal on the surface of the water and have the children kick.
- For younger infants, have the child's head rest on the parent's shoulder (giving them a BIG hug) and have parents move their child's feet while walking backwards to give the child an idea of what kicks are like. During this motion, parents should be saying or singing softly to their kids the word "kick/s" being repetitive to let their child remember the motion and what it's called
- Bring the children to the beach end of the pool and lay out a bunch of toys to have them look for and pick up! This helps the child explore the pool comfortably because it's like a game. Parents need to be there holding their child if they have trouble walking in the water or if they cannot walk on their own.

Lesson # 4 Learn back float

- Lots of Twinkle, Twinkle today! Start with the basic back float, and as children relax and get comfortable, have the parent move the child's head from their shoulder to their chest.
- Be sure parents are slowly moving around, this helps relaxing the child and makes it easier to gradually move from shoulder to chest
- If a child becomes comfortable floating on their back with ears in the water, try to have them do it on their own eventually starting rollovers.

Lesson #5 Practice swimming to the wall

- Grabbing the wall is a learned skill; kids don't do it on their own. Teach parents to encourage their child to grab their parent's hand after submersions – don't always rescue them by grabbing them. For the more advanced kids, have them do "Humpty Dumpty" and swim back to the wall. Also have them swim back and forth from the wall and a dock or parent.
- Using toys also helps, put a ball or ring on the wall and have their child try to grab it

Lesson #6 Learn front pass/glide

- Using the sandwich hold, pass kids back and forth from yourself and the parent. Be sure to always use a cue: "1-2-3!" Start out above the water, then just under the surface, then all the way under. Do not let go of the kids until they are used to the pass. Once they have adjusted, start letting go so that they glide a short distance. Advanced kids should be underwater by themselves for 2 to 6 seconds. Increase swimming distance so that kids are encouraged to kick.

Lesson #7 Learn safe entry and exit on cue

- It is important to know how to safely enter and exit a pool that doesn't have steps. Parents should practice getting into the water safely with their kids from the side of the pool. Both sit down side by side (if the child can sit safely already). While holding the child with one hand, the parent rolls over so that their hands are on both sides of the child and while facing the wall, and then slides into the pool. Next the parent lifts the child into the water. Place the kids' hands on the side of the pool to practice holding. Gradually begin letting go so that they eventually are holding onto the wall on their own. For exit: encourage the child to climb out unassisted by using their "elbow, elbow, tummy, knee, knee"

Lesson #8 Jump in and return to wall

- From seated or standing position depending on age and skill level. Parents must always cue their kids – do not let the kids jump in without being cued. Kids jump into water; parent rotates kid and sends them back to the side of the pool.
- For kids who are hesitant using toys can be very helpful to get them in/out of the water

Lesson #9 Fun day/circuit day

- Use extra toys … beach balls … mat … dock …
- Turn on the lemon drops on beach and use the play structure. Go down slides, play with the geysers, etc..
- Have toys out, and let children walk around and pick them up

Lesson #10 Safety Tips

- "Don't Just Pack it, Wear Your Lifejacket!" Before class, set out appropriately sized lifejackets for each student in your class, teach parents safety tips on how to use them and when children should be wearing a life jacket. For the lesson, have parents practice putting them on, taking them off, and letting their child float around (with little to no support from parents)
- "Too Much Fun in the Sun" Go over safety tips on how too much sun can be dangerous, discuss sunscreen, shade for their child, using hats, etc.
- "Look Before you Leap" Jumping in the water is fun, but not being able to see what's under the water can be dangerous. Discuss to the parents the safety of checking their environment before going in. Tell them to ask themselves "How deep is it?", "Is it too cold?", "Are there sharp rocks or objects that could hurt me?" This is very important to go over, and even practice in during the lesson; place toys sinking objects as well as floating objects in the water, and ask the parents whether or not it is safe to jump, if their child is going to jump on anything or anyone.

Tips for teaching children 3 years & younger

Be confident
Believe in yourself! You are a talented instructor who knows much more about swimming than the parents do. Being prepared will prevent you from feeling intimidated by the parents in the class. Know and be able to communicate why we review each skill, how it should be done, and when to move to the next level. Swimming is a progression, you have to be patient and develop a solid foundation to build upon. Be ready to answer any questions regarding the curriculum and be able to answer specific questions. If you're confident, the parents are as well, and if they feel confident so will the child, which is our ultimate goal. Knowing as much as you can about early child development will also help your confidence. Continue to educate yourself and find new ways to improve your class.

Communicate and interact with parents
Instruct your class through the parent. Always address the parent and make sure they know why you are doing a certain skill. Parents also need to know when they need to be a little more aggressive, especially with the back float. Most kids do not like doing the back float at first. Therefore, if parents know they need to be a bit more forceful while distracting the child with songs and toys, the child will eventually become comfortable with the back float. Teachers should respect the special relationship between infants and their parents and understand that parents are the infant's first and more important teachers. However, some older kids will respond better to the instructor. Find out what is best for each child.

Be expressive/enthusiastic and caring

Give varying levels of difficulty for each skill
You will have kids who are 6 months to 3 years old in these classes. You must be prepared to show each skill in at least 3 different ways; from the easiest level to the most challenging. Use the more advanced children to demonstrate the more advanced way to practice a skill and vise-versa.

Safety comes first!
Keep checking parents to make sure they are holding their child properly and safely and are focused on their child. Parents sometimes talk to one another and may not notice that their child's face is in the water. It is your responsibility to keep reminding parents to always check their child's face to avoid any unnecessary inhaling or swallowing of water. At times you may have parents in the class that are very anxious to make their children progress fast. They usually like to "dunk" their child in as much as possible. It is important for you to notify these parents of the risks involved in going under too many times at such an early age (hyponatremia, anxiety, fear, etc.). Also notice if the child is too cold. If so, suggest that they get out early that day or keep most of the child's body submerged the remainder of the lesson.

Know the level of swimming that child in your class can reach
This will help you take each child in your class to the highest level they can reach.

Overall
We focus on making kids more comfortable in the water so that they can enjoy swim lessons. We believe that when kids are more confident, they will learn swimming and have a more positive experience. It may take longer for kids to be safe in the water, but they take the less aggressive and more fun approach to teaching kids how to swim. Parent/tot classes are meant to be a fun parent/child bonding experience. It's also a great

way to meet other moms & dads.

Bubbles or no bubbles

Blowing bubbles is an advanced skill that kids can learn after they have learned to hold their breath underwater. Most kids under 2 can't blow bubbles so it isn't really worth your time to teach them. The benefits of having them hold their breath instead of blowing bubbles is that when their lungs stayed filled with air, it easier to float. There are times though that bubbles can help children overcome the anxiety of having water on their face. When they blow big bubbles water gets splashed on their face and slowly they can make the bubbles lower and lower in the water.

Repetition

Kids learn by repetition and routines. Don't feel like they would be bored doing the same routines. Adults may get bored, but for kids it becomes more exciting when they start to recognize routines. They also feel less scared when you do the same things each lesson and they know what to expect next.

Developmental

Get to know your child and what works best for them. Some like counting, some singing, and some just talking a lot. Always explain what you're going to do next and that you'll help, but keep your language simple; they'll get lost in long multi-step explanations or directions.
Even if your swimmer can't talk yet they can often understand you. Kids understand language before they are able to pronounce words.

Difference between kids at this age

Each child is different and progresses at different speeds - there are a lot of 2 year olds that are ready for Preschool Level 2. However there are also a lot of 3 year olds that are not ready for Preschool Level 1. Determine the child's level and mold the lesson to his/her ability. Don't be afraid to push and be firm with the kids – they can learn a lot if you expect them to.

Criers

Get them comfortable with you. Be silly and excited. Smile a lot. Hold them close to you. Always assure them that you're there for them and that you will not let anything happen to them. Say thing like; "I'm holding you so tight, I won't let you get hurt" Use lots of toys & songs! Distract them – talk about favorite foods, colors, TV shows. If they want a toy, make them stop crying before they can have the toy. Get them in the water and off the steps ASAP. Be firm with kids having a tantrum. Tell them "mommy will come back after class" or "mommy just went to the bathroom, she'll be right back" or "all done crying" or "big kids don't cry" Assure parents that crying is normal. Don't let the parents take the kid out right away or cancel the lessons because of the crying – it sets a bad precedent and the child will know that crying works, so they'll continue doing it.

Plan Ahead

Have enough props and toys for all the different activities you would like do. Start slowly and wait till they adjust to the water one little step at a time. You can repeat different skills with different props; Back float with you holding them/with noodle/board and the same with front float, kicking etc. Also, submerging to wall/steps/mom if in. Use songs and games to make each activity last longer.Keep them moving and warm Keep their bodies underwater in a horizontal position whenever possible.

Temperature

If a kid is shivering, check for "temperature fatigue". Push your thumb on the bottom of the child's foot or on his/her back. Quickly remove your thumb. The color should reappear on the back within 3 seconds and on the bottom of the foot within 5 seconds. If the color takes longer the child is too cold and you should finish the lesson early or try an activity that will warm them up like kicking or arm movements, but keep checking their temperature. If the color comes back quick they are probably just very nervous and are shivering as a result of their emotions. Calm them down and make sure they trust you. Remember they could be shivering just b/c they are nervous – not cold

Submerge

Blow on their face or not? Kids do not need you to blow on their face. Some parents even think it's rude to "spit" on their kids. I prefer if you use "cueing" to teach kids to hold their breath underwater. Ready, set, go….or 1, 2, 3 or as part of a song … "splashes splashes we all fall down". Start with small dips underwater and then gradually get kids to go under for longer periods (no more than 5 seconds) and deeper.
At first maintain a horizontal body position when submerging. Small scoops towards the parent at first. Try vertical submersions for bobs only once they are comfortable going under. Kids may get water up their nose when submerged vertically but if they fall in the pool they will fall vertically.
Advanced kids can be rolled over straight to a back float for a breath after submerging. Slowly build up to taking a breath by rolling over on back and then rolling over to swim again.
Sometimes in the beginning kids swallow water. Watch for this and limit the number of times you allow them to go under. Kids can get very sick from drinking too much water. It's called hyponatremia. It's very rare but also very serious. For beginners, 5 submersions per class is enough.

Back float

Float on their backs a lot; it is one of the most important/hard skills for new swimmers. Sing "Twinkle Twinkle Little Star", "ABC's" or count to 10. Start with resting head on instructors shoulder with back support and Progressively support head and back with hands then just the head. Be sure to maintain horizontal position at all times. Moving while floating helps to keep the body horizontal. Creating an upward current under the body (while slowly letting go of the child) is also a great way to help a child float. Stand behind them and tell them to "look at my eyes." This makes them tilt their head back and the eye contact is reassuring.
Reward kids for being still and relaxed on back float. Don't stop the float when they are anxious and crying – stop it when they relax and calm down - even if they relax only for a second.

Wall crawl/Wall Grab

Kids under 1 should practice grabbing the wall. Wall crawl for kids over one years old. Make sure their chins don't hit the wall.
Sing "Itsy Bitsy Spider" drop rain on their head while crawling or pretend you're a choo-choo train. Who wants to be the engine? Or play "red light, green light".
Hold student on back and progressively loosen the grip. When comfortable have them fall off wall and grab back on. Fall off, turn around and grab back on is for even more advanced students.
Songs/Games
Straight leg kicks while holding onto mat, teacher's arm, or sitting on stairs. Demonstrate the kicks and be sure student(s) are kicking correctly. Play red light green light (add yellow light, blue light…)
Splashing ABC's - sing ABC's & make it "rain" or just splash a lot. You can throw a splash ball back and forth and really splash them. Laugh about it and tell them to get you back. When you throw the ball count or say

the ABC's with every throw. Try to get kids wet as much as possible.
Throw some floating toys out in the pool and take a bucket or kickboard as your treasure chest to go pick them up. Make kids use their hands to grab toys or submerge kids towards a toy to see if they grab it.

Children that are comfortable in the water and swim regularly can often reach these levels of difficulty:

- 6 months to 2 years:
    - Swim 2 to 5 seconds underwater alone from teacher to parent
    - Very relaxed in a back float with or without assistance
    - Rollover from back to front
    - Rollover from front to back to take a breath – tell parents how difficult it is for a child to lift their head to breath – it also ruins body positions in the water (makes them too vertical)
    - Swim to wall, docks and steps
    - Wall crawls
    - Elementary kicks
    - Sitting and falling off the wall – return to wall, not parent

- 2 to 3 years:
    - Front floats and kicks
    - Bobs
    - Get rings off of steps or tot dock
    - Independence from parent - spend time with instructor to prep for future lessons
    - Rollovers
    - Swim from wall around teacher and back to wall
    - Jump in and return to wall unassisted
    - Dive under and get rings
    - Safe entry and exit on cue

Silliman Aquatics Lesson Plans

Tips for Teaching Preschoolers

General Information
Whenever a child is coughing, be alert. The child might have swallowed a lot of water, and sometimes the child might throw up. Get the child to the side of the pool so they will not throw up in the pool.

Communicating with parents
Instructors should be speaking with parents before and

after every class. You should be informing parents about their kid(s), what they need to work on, what they're doing great on, or any issues such as crying, whining, or not listening. This way parents are able to help you with disciplining, calming, and or asserting the student to pay attention. Not only does this make it easier on you to finish your lesson, but also the parent(s) will see that you are trying.

YOU are the teacher
Know your lesson plan and follow it. Do not be discouraged by students who do not listen, if they don't want to participate no matter how hard you try, it's okay to move on to the next student who will. Speak to the parents after class discussing their lack of interest and what you can possibly do differently to include that student next class.

Be confident in yourself!
Do not get distracted or discouraged by those "helicopter parents", if parents are watching you, it is because they want to be able to hear and see what it is that you are doing. In this case, be LOUD, exaggerate what you are practicing, and show the parents that you know what you are doing. For instance, arm circles on the wall: count out loud, do it together, and exaggerate your arm circles. Be as enthusiastic as you can be!

Standing on the wall
Keep in mind your preschool swimmers are small and will get cold faster if they are not being active. Try to avoid keeping them on the wall and instead incorporate group activities such as "red light, green light", "Ring around the rosie", and supermans. Use barbells, kickboards, or even noodles for help students float on their own and to get them off the wall to do kicks, glides, or arm circles.

Dealing with cryers and hyper/energetic kids
Remember you are teaching kids between the ages 3-6. Majority of these kids have never been in a pool yet so their first reaction will be fear and hesitation. Do not force these kids into the pool right away, instead you can encourage them in with toys, play at the beach or on the stairs, or turn on the play structure. For kids who are too attached to their parents, have the parent wait in the lobby or out of sight of the child and let them cry it out and get used to their parent not being around. Do not be afraid to hold them! (feel free to ask the senior to hop in and help out as well). For hyper kids who have difficulty paying attention, try different teaching methods, play games, make everything into a competition, engage your students to make them want to participate. For example, for students who do not want to do arm circles you can say "I bet my arm circles are better than yours!" this can help in getting your students more engaged and interested in being part of the lesson.

Preschool Levels 3 - 6 years old 2 - 4 students per class

Preschool Level 1

This introductory class is for children who are new to swimming or nervous in the water. Our goal is to develop confidence, breath control and proper body position. Positive reinforcement is our main focus to help the child build trust and confidence. Graduates will be able to do 5 relaxed bobs, front float/back float for 5 seconds with support, jump to teacher from the wall and relax in an assisted back float.

Goals & Objectives

- Submersion of the face

- Wall crawl
- Safely enter and exit the water independently
- Pick up 3 objects off stairs or shallower end (towards beach)
- Blow bubbles
- Bobbing with bubbles and air exchange
- Assisted front float for 5+ seconds
- Assisted relaxed back float with ears in the water
- Supported kicking on front and back
- Jump from wall to instructor
- Streamlines
- 911 and pool rules

Detailed Lesson Plan

- Practice bobs out of water/on stairs.
- Get bodies and face wet on stairs. Use a sponge or a bucket; Start with a little bit and slowly add more and more water. Make it fun.
- Get face wet or Submerge (when child is ready) (sing "Humpty Dumpty", "Ring Around the Rosies"). Try to maintain a horizontal body position when submerging. A vertical position can force water up the nose.
- Straight leg kicks while holding onto wall, teacher's arm, or sitting on stairs. Demonstrate the kicks and be sure student(s) are kicking correctly.
- Blow bubbles. Start inside a bucket or a ring held at the surface and slowly progress to blowing bubbles underwater.
- Wall crawl (sing "Itsy Bitsy Spider" drop rain on head while crawling). Hold student on back and progressively loosen the grip.
- Bobs on steps or wall. Start with 1-2 and move up to five. Make sure student(s) are relaxed, taking a breath above water and exhaling underwater.
- Float on back (sing "Twinkle Twinkle Little Star"). Start with holding bar bells or hugging a kickboard. Then resting head on instructors shoulder with back support. Progressively support head and back with hands then just the head. Be sure to maintain horizontal position at all times. Moving while floating helps to stay horizontal.
- Demonstrate and practice streamline out of water/on stairs. Making sure arms are raised to the ears.
- Reinforce small fast straight leg kicks. Use kick boards, bar bells, or your arms.
- Teach front float with face submerged. Submerging your face and looking at the student(s) underwater can help them relax while floating. Also you can push child to wall then have them push of the wall and float back to you. Start close and slowly move farther away.
- Introduce back propulsion off the wall (assisted). Ears wet, gently push off and float to teacher or dock. Make sure head is back and tummy is up when they push off.
- Sit out of water hands up as in streamline and fall in towards teacher. (sit dive) Chop Chop timber!
- Jump from pool deck and return to wall.
- On the last day of lessons touch we have water safety day, go over one of multiple water safety scenarios such as calling 911 in emergencies, wearing a life jacket, and reviewing basic pool rules and why we have them. (i.e. no running, no diving in shallow water, no horseplay, etc.).

Preschool Level 2

This class is for children who are comfortable in the pool and will go underwater willingly and happily. In this level the focus is on learning proper breathing techniques, improving floating skills, kicking strength and survival skills. Graduates will be able to do (unsupported) back floats and front floats comfortably, streamline with straight leg kicks, propulsive kicks on back, rollovers and front crawl.

Goals & Objectives

- Unsupported front/back floats (10 seconds or more)
- Streamline with kicks
- Combined arm circles and kicks at least 2 body lengths
- Back float with kicks
- Breath exchange while kicking with prop
- Introduce rollovers
- Pick up 3 objects independently in chest deep water
- Jump in and rollover to back to call for help

Detailed Lesson Plan

- Practice straight leg kicks out of water/on stairs (red light green light)
- 10 advanced bobs holding on to side of pool or squatting to the bottom of the pool and shooting back up with arms raised as in streamline.
- Streamline with kicks out to wall or instructor. Make sure face is pointed down towards the floor of the pool.
- Straight leg kicks across pool with barbell or kickboard (teacher at mid pool). Make sure head comes up only for a quick breath and then back down towards the bottom of the pool. Arms and legs straight.
- Back-float and kicks with/without kickboard. Advanced kids can rotate body side to side; shoulder turned toward chin and hip turned to the side.
- Sit out of water on the wall, hands in streamline, fall in and swim towards teacher, around teacher, or around teacher through an upright hula-hoop.
- Show kid(s) how to swim to the bottom of the pool and get fish or rings. Show them how to bend at the waist and pretend like they are going to touch their feet and then kick towards the object at the bottom.
- Practice freestyle arms out of water/on stairs. Make sure arms are reaching behind or above head and stretching in front of face, not on the sides.
- Perfect streamline and kicks to wall or across pool
- Rollovers back to front then front to back. Call it "roly-poly" or "pancakes"
- On the last day of the session touch on safety in the water. If the kid(s) ever feel too tired to get to wall or steps while swimming, teach them to float on their back (they can breathe, call for help and it doesn't require too much effort). Practice by dropping kid(s) in the deep end (vertically) and have them turn to their back.

Preschool Level 3

This level is for children who are able to swim independently and are ready to be introduced to some competitive strokes. In this advanced level, graduates will be able to swim freestyle with side breathing at least 5 times consistently, backstroke for 4 body lengths, rollovers, streamline glides for 2 body lengths, elementary backstroke, and sidekicks if time allows. (Youth 3 is when they will learn dolphin kicks and

breaststroke kicks)

Goals & Objectives

- Side breathing
- Backstroke
- Rollovers
- Streamline
- Introduction to side swimming (kicking on side)
- Elementary Backstroke
- Streamlines

Detailed Lesson Plan

- Side glides with kick. This is tricky for most kids; you have to show that the kicks go from side to side instead of up and down. Make sure shoulder is turned towards the chin and the hip is turned sideways. For some kids leaning a little bit towards the back helps a lot. But, make sure they are not turned on their backs completely. Use barbell or kickboard to help in the beginning.
- More advanced kids can practice swimming this drill: 6 kicks and 1 arm stroke or 6 kicks and 3 arm strokes.
- Challenge the kids to swim freestyle with clean and quiet arms. Make sure they are still kicking fast and the head is down when not breathing.
- Work on freestyle, making sure head position is correct, arms are reaching out of the water, and the legs are still kicking fast. Also, make sure your kid(s) turn to the side (to back in the beginning) for each breath. Most kids will breathe to the side the first couple of times, but lift their heads after that.
- Practice catch-up freestyle with/without a kickboard. Make sure body (belly button included) is not staying flat on top of the water, but turning side to side.
- Elementary backstroke. Monkey, Airplane, Soldier. Teaches arm propulsion for backstroke and also a great way to teach proper breaststroke kicks. Make sure knees do not come out of the water and are not too far apart.
- Have the kid(s) do a sit dive or kneeling dive into a hula-hoop that you hold upright in the water. Only do sit dives.
- On the last day of the session touch on safety tips when helping another child (friend or family member) that is nearly drowning. Practices reach or throw, don't go, with the kid(s) using a noodle or their arm. Make sure kids know never to jump in to save a friend/sibling. Always get an adult to help. Another safety discussion could be on pool rules associated with diving. When is it safe to dive?

Teaching Youth Swimmers

Tips for Teaching Youth Swimmers

Attitude and Rude Behavior

If your youth swimmer is rude and disrespectful towards you, do not give attitude back; you are the adult. Speak

to the student and if they still refuse to listen speak to their parent(s) after class, inform them about their behavior during lessons, and discuss how next class can be better.

Participation in Groups
Class should be ran with all students actively participating. Try to avoid teaching 1-on-1 most of the class (unless it's a private) For higher level students it will be easier for them to all go out and swim at once. However for lower level students incorporate group activities and use given resources such as the barbells to help.

Be a Confident Instructor!
Showing your students you're the expert helps set authority in your class. Know your level and what they need to pass and be sure to correct strokes to avoid bad swimming habits such as arms crossing over, feet sinking while kicking, or raising their heads in side breathing. These are major habits that should be fixed before moving on to higher levels.

Youth Levels 6 - 12 years old 2 - 6 students per class

Youth Level 1

The focus of this level is to build confidence and learn basic water safety skills through fun and games. Graduates will be able to do (supported) small fast kicks front and back for 2 body lengths, front floats with full face in the water, back floats with ears in the water, full head submersions at least 5 times, possibly introduced to elementary backstroke, rollovers, and comfortably perform alternating arms and leg action for 2 body lengths.

Goals & Objectives

- Streamline on stomach with fast kicks
- Efficient kicks on back
- Bobbing with bubbles and air exchange
- Jump in and recover independently
- Elementary backstroke
- Front Crawl
- Rollovers
- Retrieve objects on bottom of pool

Lesson Plan

- Practice relaxed, controlled bobs.
- Advanced kids can practice breath exchange while kicking on board or noodle.
- Learn streamlines on deck or steps.
- Front Floats
- Streamlines off the wall or stairs (with support) using kickboards, noodle, or barbells
- Back float - add kicks when ready
- Elementary Backstroke
- Rollovers
- Practice freestyle arms out of the water. Focus on long strokes and straight arms
- Freestyle arms - calm & quiet & no splashes. At first just do 3 strokes and stop. When comfortable teach them to roll on their back to breathe.

- Retrieving objects off the bottom of the pool blowing bubbles and practicing breath exchange
- Reaching Assists: do not jump in pool to save a friend. Practice handing them a noodle while you call out to an adult for help.

Youth Level 2

This class focuses on introducing independent swimming to the swimmers. Graduates should be able to do (all unsupported) front and back floats, combined arm circles and kicks for 3 body lengths with introduction to side breathing, kicks on back for 5 body lengths, elementary backstroke and introduction to sidekicks if time allows.

Goals & Objectives

- Side swimming
- Side breathing
- Freestyle
- Backstroke
- Improved streamlines before swimming any stroke.
- Introduce streamline kicks on back
- Safe, shallow dives

Lesson Plan

- Increase distance and efficiency with flutter kicks, heels come out of the water
- Focus on side kicking. Relaxed, nose close to armpit, turn tummy to breathe
- Rollovers should be perfect now. Back to front and front to back.
- Increase distance of freestyle with rollovers.
- Introduce side breathing. Start at wall or on steps. Talk to the fish, listen to the fish.
- Next get kickboard or barbell. One arm at side, one arm on board/bar. Kick and then turn tummy to breathe.
- Catch up on kickboard. Practice breathing to dominant side first. Bilateral breathing can come later.
- Challenge the kids to swim freestyle with clean and quiet arms. Make sure they are still kicking fast and the head is down when not breathing. At first have them swim 3- 4 arms without a breath and stop. Once these look good then have them roll on their back to get a breath. When they are doing that really well then you can introduce side breathing.
- Introduce side breathing by having them swim across the width (beginner) and length (advanced) of the pool doing 6 kicks and 1 arm stroke or 6 kicks and 3 arm strokes.
- When swimming look down at 6:00, when breathing look at 3:00 and 9:00.
- No space between ear and shoulder (pillow) when side breathing.
- You can also use a kickboard to practice side breathing. 3 seconds face in the water both hands on the kickboard and then take an arm pull and a breath. Advanced kids should alternate sides.
- Have one arm holding the middle of the kick board, one arm by your side. Kick for 4 kicks facing down and then rotate to one side to breathe for 4 kicks. Arms do not move, just your body. Teach kids to turn their hips to breathe.
- Review and improve back kicks. Advanced kids can rotate body side to side; shoulder turned toward chin and hips turned to the side. Also can introduce streamline kicks on back.
- Review Elementary Backstroke
- Introduce backstroke arms. Chin back, chest high. Shallow pull, push hand (water) to your leg. Make

sure pull and rotation are timed correctly. Practice backstroke arms out of the water or on the steps. Use " Thumb up, Pinky in"

- Have the kids do a knee dive (sit dive if in drop) and swim across pool to the wall. One toe on the edge and one knee on the edge. Teacher should be in water helping the child's hands enter the water first. More advanced kids should be taught to streamline (and kick of course) for 5 sec after every dive before they start swimming. Keep all dives shallow and supervise carefully. Make sure kids know they can only dive during lessons when the teacher says go.
- Dedicate part of the final lesson to teach students what to do in an emergency around the pool. If someone looks like they're drowning, do not jump in to help, instead reach with arm or an object and call for help while doing so. If the person is out of reach, try to find a floating device to throw to them. Practice these skills briefly.

Youth Level 3

The goal of this class is to introduce and practice all competitive strokes and to prepare our swimmers for Lap pool. Emphasis will be placed on the basics of the competitive strokes such as dolphin kicks 3-5 body lengths, breaststroke kicks 5 body lengths, freestyle with side breathing at least 10 times, backstroke at least 4 body lengths, and elementary backstroke for 5 body lengths. Advancing students may learn breaststroke and butterfly if time permits.

Goals & Objectives

- Freestyle & Backstroke with proper rotation
- Dolphin kicks
- Breaststroke kicks
- Safe dives
- Elementary backstroke review
- Advanced swimmers should be introduced to sidestroke
- Advanced swimmers should learn butterfly and breaststroke arms

Lesson Plan

- Begin with a "warm up". For example: 1 length freestyle, 1 length dolphin kicks .
- Count their strokes – encourage them to take the least amount of strokes – turn it into a game
- Improve their side breathing. Use kickboards, lots of side swimming drills, fins. Make sure they do not lift their head before or after they side breath.
- Make sure their bodies are rotating from side to side while swimming free and back
- Should always streamline (and kick) for 5 seconds before swimming freestyle. For advanced kids get them to streamline before beginning backstroke as well
- For advanced backstroke drills have the kid(s) do 10 kicks on one side, turn to their back quickly, and switch to other side. Make sure their face is out of the water at all times.
- Once your kid(s) have a good feel for breaststroke kicks, you can introduce breaststroke arms. On the stairs, have the kid(s) make an "ice cream" bowl in front of their chest, scoop all around the bowl and serve it to your friends. Using a noodle to practice breaststroke arms around the pool, helps a lot.
- Basic Breaststroke notes: Pull, breathe, kick, and glide. Make them say it over and over. Use noodle under arm pits to help with breaststroke arms. Small shallow pull in front of your chest. Get in front of kids and move hands, pull forward for the glide. Eyes down all the time.
- Basic Fly notes: kick, kick, pull. Arms just like freestyle. Use 2 cups to help with fly arms. Back of

swimmers' hands touch in front. Arms in, butt up. Don't move head around, eyes down. Kick more when you get tired.

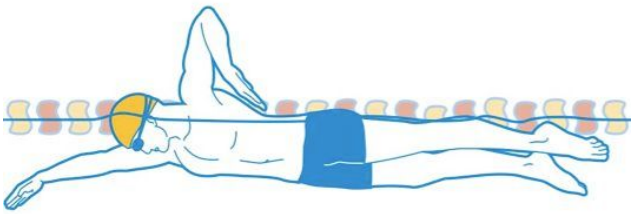
- Introduce butterfly arms (keeping thumbs down). Have the kid(s) try three/four butterfly (dolphin) kicks and one arm pull.
- Show students where AED and pool telephone are. What to do to assist lifeguards in case of emergency.

Youth Level 4

This class focuses on building endurance for level 5 Youth and competitive swimming as well as going more in depth on correcting competitive strokes. Classes will be in Lap pool. Graduates will be able to perform adequate freestyle for 25 yards, backstroke for 25 yards, butterfly for 15 yards, breaststroke for 15 yards, elementary backstroke for 25 yards, side strokes and introduction to treading as well as flip and open turns.

Goals & Objectives

- Building endurance for level 5 Youth
- Perfecting all competitive strokes
- Freestyle 25 yards
- Backstroke 25 yards
- Butterfly 15 yards
- Breaststroke 15 yards
- Elementary backstroke for 25 yards
- Sidestroke
- Introduction to open and flip turns
- Introduction to treading



Lesson Plan

- Begin class with a "warm up". For example 1-2 lap freestyle, 1-2 lap kicks, etc.
- Improve any strokes with drills
- Arrange the drills where students will be focusing on one to three strokes per class i.e. first week will be working on improving freestyle, backstroke, and breaststroke; second week will be working with butterfly, sidestroke, and elementary backstroke. (weekend classes will definitely work with up to 3 strokes each class)
- Drills can be found on **Instructor's Corner** (or if you know of any from swim teams you may incorporate it into your lesson plan as well)
- Freestyle drills can include: 1) fingertip drag to reinforce arm recovery: students will swim freestyle and with relaxed arms drag their fingertips across the surface of the water. 2) Hand touch drill to focus on strokes and endurance: students will start in streamline position, while one arm begins the stroke, fully extended, the other arm will remain in front until the stroking arm completes the stroke back to the other arm.
- Backstroke drills: 1) slow stroke is used to strengthen back kicks: similar to hand touch in freestyle, have students kick off the wall in streamline on their backs, one arm begins the stroke while the other remains above their head, once the stroking arm completes the stroke switch.
- Breaststroke drills: 3-1 drill, 1-3 drill, kicking and breathing
- More on instructor's corner!
- Introduce flip turns and open turns. For flip turns, break it down into 5 easy steps: the approach, the flip, the plant, the take-off, and the streamline.

    - Start off by explaining the concept of what a flip turn is and how to position your body. Have them do somersaults in the water, for those who do not know how, have them tuck their chin to their chest as well as knees to their chest, forming into a tight ball, teachers can assist by putting one hand on the back of the neck and the other on one of their ankles and spinning them. Be sure students know to blow air through their nose as water could rush up while turning. Have them practice this with you a few times before them doing it themselves.
    - Once your students understand the concept and are able to do a full somersault on their own, line up your class under the flags and have them freestyle one at a time to the wall, once arm's length away have them do a somersault, planting their feet on the floor and standing straight up. Eventually you will have them swim to the wall, flip, and kick off the wall taking off in streamline position
    - Open turns are a lot more easier, both hands touch the wall, kick off into a streamline and resume strokes.
- To introduce treading, start off by going over a few sculling drills. One of the popular ways to tread water consists of sculling water in a horizontal plane with your arms and flutter kicking in a vertical plane with your legs. You are able to use a noodle to help float better.

Youth Level 5

The goal of this class is to prepare swimmers for competitive swim. Emphasis will be on refining techniques in all competitive strokes and introducing flip turns. Graduates will move onto competitive swim or be able to join a swim team. They will be able to perform a 50 yard freestyle with flip turn, 50 yards of backstroke with flip turn, 25 yards of butterfly, 25 yards of sidestroke, 25 yards of breaststroke, 25 yards of elementary backstroke, and be able to tread for at least 5 minutes

Goals & Objectives

- Building endurance for competitive swim
- Perfecting all competitive strokes
- Freestyle 50 yards
- Backstroke 50 yards
- Butterfly 25 yards
- Breaststroke 25 yards
- Elementary backstroke for 25 yards
- Side Stroke
- Flip Turns/Open Turns
- Treading for 5 minutes

Lesson Plan

- Warm up: 2-4 laps freestyle
- Begin with drills on the focused strokes for that day
- Make sure to perfect all strokes and turns! This level is all about perfecting your student's techniques
- Have some fun in your class! Turn some drills into a race or a game
- For most drills, have students perform/practice their flip turns and open turns
- Introduce IMs and relays to start readying your students for competitive swim (remember: IM order is always fly, black, breast, free)
- End the class with skullying drills and 5 minutes of treading, again, make it into a competition to see

who can last the longest!

Competitive Swim Lessons 7-17 years old 10 per class

This course is designed for those who have completed the Youth Level 5, or age group swimmers who no longer have their swim team workouts. Class will focus on the 4 main competitive strokes in a structured swim workout environment. Classes will consist of drills meant to refine swimmers techniques, timing, and to keep up their endurance as well.

Goals & Objectives

- Refining and perfecting swimmers techniques
- Timing
- Keeping up their endurance

Lesson Plan

- Start of with some warm ups, a couple laps of freestyle and/or backstroke.
- Get into more intense drills which will focus on breathing, endurance, and sprints.
- Breathing drills:
    - Examples: Alternate breathing patterns: Swim 250 yards, 25 yards breathing every 6th stroke, 50 yards every 5th stroke bilateral breathing, 75 every 4th stroke, 100 every 3rd stroke (bilateral breathing)
- Endurance drills:
    - Counting strokes (DPS = Distance Per Stroke): have students complete a lap of regular freestyle and count their strokes. Have the swimmer try to keep their stroke count per length consistent.
- Another endurance drill to work on their kicks called kick around, where students will swim a 100: 25 kicks on the front, 25 kicks on the side, 25 kicks on the other side, 25 kicks on back.
- Sprinting drills such as Sprinting every other set: Have students swim 200 or 300 yards; 25 sprint, 25 easy
- More drills and mini-swim sets can be found @ www.100swimmingworkouts.com
- Timing is important in Competitive Swim! Stop watches are in the guard room and report cards have a section to write down their times.
- Feel free to talk to parents or students to ask what they want to work on the most and what times they would like to improve on.

Teaching Adults to Swim

The Adult Program consists of three levels (tentative class description for Fall 2017):

Conquering Your Fear of the Water

This class is designed to help those who are learning to swim, or are uncomfortable in the water. We will progress at each individual's own pace in a supportive environment so as to experience one of the most relaxing, body-friendly types of exercise. We will help you have fun in the water by using rings, barbells, water polo balls, flippers and foam workout noodles. If you can have fun in the water, you're one step closer to being a confident swimmer.

Swimming with Ease

This class is designed for those who are comfortable underwater but need help swimming laps. We will develop technique and gracefulness. Freestyle will be the main focus with a lot concentration of proper breathing. Additionally, you'll be introduced to the other variety of swim strokes such as breaststroke, backstroke, elementary backstroke and sidestroke.

Swimming for Fitness

This class is intended to prepare you for Masters or general lap swimming. This class will focus on building your endurance through freestyle training. We will also practice the fundamentals of the other strokes- backstroke, breaststroke, and butterfly. We will also work on flip turns and treading water.

Goals and Objectives

The purpose of the adult program is to teach adults and teens the four competitive strokes. The objective is to develop a balanced swimmer while reducing the fear and frustration many adults possess. By teaching the four strokes (Freestyle, Backstroke, Butterfly, and Breaststroke) the swimming workout utilizes more muscle groups and avoids the monotony of a single stroke swimming workout.

To effectively teach adults and teens to swim you must alter the language and tone used to teach the skills. It is necessary to use the correct terminology and instead of teaching through play and imagery, more concrete analogies and descriptions are necessary. Adults and teens require more verbal explanation of what you are expecting them to do. Give reasons why things are done a specific way and answer their questions.

Adult Beginners

The beginner adult who is a complete non-swimmer will most likely possess many fears and anxieties about the water and swimming. They will not display their fears as a child would. Discuss their anxieties and previous experiences with the water and try to calm them. Reassure them that you understand their fears and that it will most likely take some time to overcome them.

Fears

Below are a few of the most common fears the beginning adult might experience.

- **Fear of the water depth changing** – To work on overcoming this fear, have the swimmers hold onto the wall with both hands and walk along the entire length of the teaching station. This will allow them to get a feel for the depth of the water.
- **Fear of the unknown** – Typically this fear stems from the swimmer closing their eyes when their face is submerged into the water. Most swimmers are unaware that they do this. Encourage the swimmer to keep their eyes open. If the water bothers their eyes, suggest that the swimmer use a pair of goggles.
- **Fear of being unable to return to the upright position** – To overcome this fear, begin by having the swimmer hold the wall with both hands and allow their feet to float to the surface of the water, keeping their face out of the water. It will be necessary for the instructor to assist with the swimmers

legs when having the swimmer tuck their knees into their stomach to rotate their body, then stretch their legs out until their feet touch the bottom of the pool. Once the swimmer is comfortable doing this with their face out of the water, have the swimmer repeat this with their face in the water. Have the swimmers repeat this until they are comfortable and can go from a prone position to a standing position unassisted.

- **Fear of sinking** – Once the adult swimmer has mastered returning to an upright position, explain to the swimmers that you want them to place their hands on the bottom of the pool and keep them there as long as possible. The result will be that the adult will find that they float back to the surface of the water, they will not sink to the bottom.
- **Fear of choking or getting water in the ears or nose** – Instruct the adults to exhale. Begin by teaching them to exhale through their mouth only, then nose only, then both. You need to teach them how to blow bubbles, as this might be a new skill they are learning. For breathing out of the mouth, have the adult exhale slowly as if they were blowing out a candle. For exhaling through the nose, have the adult hum. As the instructor, put a pair of goggles on and go underwater to ensure the adults are actually exhaling slowly, not all at once.
- **Fear of moving in the water** – Have the adult hold onto a kick board and put their face in the water. Have them push off the bottom of the pool into a glide. Once they are capable of doing this skill, have them push off the wall. This might require some assistance from the instructor. The final step is to have the adult attempt a streamline.

Embarrassment:

- As a beginning adult, the most prominent anxiety will be the embarrassment the adult feels. As the instructor, you must be sensitive to this and avoid teaching near young children.
- Communicate openly with the adult swimmers to establish why they want to learn to swim. This will lead you into a discussion about their fears, anxieties, and assist you in developing a strategy to effectively teach them.
- The adult swimmer needs encouragement as they might become impatient with their progress, as they will expect fast results. Explain to the adults that learning to swim and overcome their fears takes time.

Additional tips:

- For adults with longer hair, suggest that they wear a swim cap.
- Use teaching aids such as kick boards, pull buoys, and fins, but be careful not to overuse them.
- Recommend that the adults practice exhaling either in the bathtub or a sink. This will be one of the most difficult skills they will need to master.
- Encourage the adults to keep practicing, however to never practice swimming alone.
- The adults will master skills at different paces. Allow the swimmers to continue practicing a skill until they are confident. Circulate through the adults in the class to offer assistance and encouragement. Give each swimmer skills to work on while assisting the other adults in the class.

Teaching Tips For Each Stroke

Freestyle and Backstroke are long-axis strokes

Bodies should be making full rotations (side to side) with each pull. Make sure hips (core body) are rotating effortlessly. When kicking on your side, lengthen your body with weightless arms.

- Freestyle arms:

    - Relax and stay loose
    - Take long quiet arm pulls (no splashes) with the least amount of pulls per lap (good goal: 25 yards with 20 strokes; Olympic swimmers take about 15 strokes)
    - Almost catch-up: keep reaching forward until the other hand is ready to enter the water; one hand should always be reaching forward
    - Anchor your hand and hold on to the water as if you were pulling your body past a rung on a ladder
    - Fingertips down: fingertips should always be pointing down, fingertip drag should help with this
    - Accelerate your underwater pull: use paddles or catch-up drill to help
    - Recover when your arms are out of the water; power on (when your hands are underneath the water), power off (when your hands are out of the water)
- Use drills: small pieces are much easier to swallow
  Good drills: catch-up, fingertip drag, one arm
- Simplify: pick one thing to work on each lap(s)
- Swimming requires a lot of practice, a lot of time in the water, make sure your students are swimming often!

Backstroke Tips

- To go faster, move your hips faster
- Roll both shoulders clear out of the water on every stroke cycle to maximize body roll
- Don't forget to rotate your legs along with core body
- Keep recovery arm straight
- Hold the water with your hand, then throw the water towards your feet
- Keep arms exactly opposite each other (many make the mistake of having arms "catch-up" at the hips)
- Drills: one arm, double arm, 10 kicks a side, wave the flag

Breaststroke Tips

- Keep body long and streamlined at all times
- Hands should never push water towards your feet
- Breath by lifting body, not your chin
- Always thing about going forward: pull forward, breath forward, land forward and kick forward
- At the end of the kick, point your toes and squeeze all the water out from between your legs
- Do lots of kicking with students: kick in streamline, kick with hands down by your butt trying to kick your hands at the beginning of each kick, kick on back, kick with board (head out of water and head in water)
- Drills: 2 kicks 1 pull, pull with free kicks, 3 second glide after each kick

Butterfly Tips

- Stay long, low and relaxed
- Stay close to the surface
- Breath forward, land forward; breath early in the pull
- Swim with body – not arms and legs
- No overt kick – let the legs follow the body; body movement is more important than the kick
- Anchor hands at corners then move your body over hands

- Do lots of kicking with students (emphasizing the body dolphin): kick in streamline, kick with hands down by hips, kick on back, kicking with kickboard not recommended as you can't move your hips much and it therefore hurts your back
- Drills: 3 kicks 1 arm; left arm, right arm

Stroke Drills

Always have a purpose in mind when using drills. Drills are best introduced and practiced if students know why they are doing them and how their use will improve upon performance. Make students aware of the name of the drill, it's use or purpose and how to perform it.

Freestyle drills

- Kick on surface with board in hands, face out of water
- Kick on surface, board held in one hand, face in water
- As above, but on one side
- As above, integrating side breathing every five seconds
- As above, using free arm to pull after each breath
- Arms only using pull buoy
- Swimming with fists closed
- "Zipper drill": student imagines grasping a zipper and zipping it up the side of the body as the arm recovers above the water
- "Chicken rowing": holding armpit for high elbows and body roll
- "Fingertip drag": dragging fingers through surface of the water, to keep hand recovery close to the body
- Side glide kick with 6 kicks, taking one stroke, roll to the other side of the body. Hold the side glide kick position on the opposite side for 6 kicks, take one hand and roll again
- Side glide kick with 3 strokes, making sure swimmers roll hips and shoulders on every stroke. On the third stroke, roll to the side and breathe. Repeat.

Backstroke drills

- Kick on sides with one arm extended. This is done very effectively around the perimeter of the pool, asking swimmer to hug the wall.
- Kick on back with both arms extended, hands placed one over the other, palms up, back arched
- Kick on back with arms at sides. Rolling hips but with no head movement.
- "Lane line": grasping lane line behind head and using it for propulsion
- "Double over arm backstroke": both arms at the same time with or without kicking, allowing head to flex backward for maximum shoulder stretch and development of a good hand entry position
- "Six kick": with body rolled to one side, extend the hand on that side above the head, the other hand is at the side; kick 6 times in this position, then switch hand positions and roll onto the other side for 6 more kicks; Repeat
- Single-arm swimming, with the one hand not being used held at the side
- Place an object (such as a partially filled soda can, cup, coin etc.) on the forehead of the swimmer and kick, drill or swim without the object falling off into the water; ideal for teaching proper body position and overcoming a major obstacle to good backstroke swimming: the rolling head

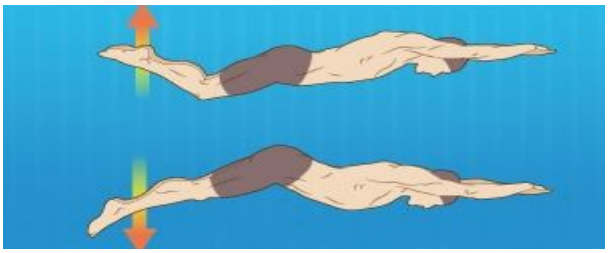
Breaststroke drills

- Kick holding board, face in water
- Kick with hands behind back, thumbs locked, push hips down, lift shoulders high, touch heels to fingers
- Kick on back, arms at side or extended overhead, looking at feet, keeping underwater
- Kicking underwater, arms extended
- Pull using a dolphin or flutter kick
- Pull once for every 2 or 3 kicks to emphasize stretch
- Pull or swim taking a breath every other pull, to deepen an excessively shallow pool
- Swim whole stroke underwater
- Kick and pull separate

Butterfly drills

- "The weave": pushing off the bottom of the pool, diving over lane lines
- "Dive stroke fly": similar to the above, except circling an entire length of a lane, touching the bottom with the hands first, then pushing upward from the bottom with the hands in front
- 6-1, 5-1, 4-1, 3-1, 2-1: first number in sequence equals number of kicks, second equals number of pulls (arm strokes can be both arms, or one arm at a time)
- 3-left, 3-right, 3-both arms, then 2-L, 2-R, 2-B arms, then 1-L, 1-R, 1-B arms
- 1-left, 1-both, 1-right, 1-both
- Sculling in the front
- Swimming with pull buoy and fins (to keep hips up and add snap to kick)

Advanced Stroke Technique & Drills



1. **Underwater dolphin kicks:** the current trend in competitive swimming! Coaches all over the world have discovered streamlining underwater with dolphin kicks is the fastest way to swim. Watch Olympic swimmers who are doing underwater dolphin kicks in every event but breaststroke.
2. **Flip turns:** start with the somersault in the water; then do 3 freestyle strokes and a somersault; next do somersaults by the wall – trying to have your feet touch the wall facing up
3. **Distance per stroke (DPS):** the most efficient way to swim in all four strokes is the take long powerful strokes, not short sloppy strokes. Have swimmers count the number of strokes it takes them to swim one lap. Try to decrease the number by lengthening the stroke.
4. **Swimming Golf:** count the number of strokes you took in one lap and add the time it took you to complete the lap and that is your golf score! The lowest score wins!
5. **Wave breaststroke:** breaststroke is becoming more and more like butterfly. Swimmers should move their hips up and down while swimming.
6. **Head down** (in line with the spine) in all strokes. Even when you breathe in breast and fly you should be looking at the bottom of the pool. Never look forward.

Group Lesson Guidelines

First Day
Be ready. Know your kids' names and ask for them. Don't just sit in the water and expect them to come to you. Have toys ready. Play a little game in the shallow end or stairs so everyone gets to know each other and then start swimming. Evaluate their skills so you know right away if they are in the correct group. Don't assume they are all as good as their parents say. Stay close and never turn your back on them. If they are not in the right group let the Aquatic Coordinator know once the lesson is over which group they should be in. We want them to like the first lesson so they want to come back. Explain to the parents today our focus is to get to know each other and review our skills. *Having fun, earning your swimmers' trust & being safe are the most important items of the day.*

Establish Safety Rules from the very beginning
- No diving or jumping from the edge of the pool
- We keep our hands and feet to ourselves
- Do not allow children to bob up and down while hanging on to the edge of the pool – split chins
- No running on deck
- No spitting water
- No splashing
- Do not get out of the pool unless the instructor says it is OK
- No chewing gum or eating while swimming
- One hand on the wall (or bottom on the steps) at all times
- Head out of water, eyes on the class at all times
- Kids must exit water when lesson is finished

Follow Proper Levels
Follow our levels exactly. Kids can move up when-ever they are ready. We don't have to wait until the session is over. When a child is ready to move up, let the Senior Guard know. They will talk to the parents about switching classes. Please let the Senior Guard know and inform the parents.

Different kids, different levels, different learning capacities
Be prepared – you will never have 2 kids at the exact same levels. You need to find ways to challenge the more advanced kids in your class while helping the more timid ones too. Here are some suggestions:
- With back float, one child could hold a board while others can do it with no support
- Two children could be practicing kicks on the steps (playing red light/green light) while you take one off the steps with a kickboard.
- One child could be practicing side breathing while the others are just refining their arms and breathing on their back.

Discipline
Be firm and in control. Reward good behavior by allowing the kids who are listening best to go first or do something fun. Teach kids they must be looking at you with their eyes and ears out of the water when you are talking. Don't be afraid to give time outs when needed. Safety is the #1 goal.

Crying/Nerves
Do not force a reluctant child to do anything they are not ready to do. Keep in mind the reasons the swimmer might not be comfortable in class could be thoughts such as "stranger danger" Keep trying with the reluctant child but avoid making them the center of attention. This will only elevate the problem. Remember all kids in your class are equally important. Learn the names of your kids as quickly as possibly and greet them each day. This will help them trust you and overcome their fears.

You almost have to expect crying on the first days of Preschool level 1 and 2. It's best in most cases to just get the kids in the water, in your arms and start singing/playing a game. Distraction is key! Letting the kids sit on the deck and cry close to mom rarely ever works. Sing songs and get the kids talking about something they love to do, "Have you seen a movie lately?" or "What's your favorite video game?"are good suggestions.

Patterns & Group Movement
One of the most important lessons we can teach you is group movement! This technique will make your teaching time much easier while also enhancing your class control. Group movement is defined as swim patterns to keep the children in your classes moving. Nobody wants to see children sitting on the side of the wall not doing anything in their classes. Each parent wants to get "all of their lesson" This technique keeps kids occupied and focused. Children are often impatient and have difficulty waiting for their turn. From the first lesson it is important to teach the swimmers the concepts of group movement.

Effective use of group movement will allow:
You to spend less time disciplining the class, leaving more time to accomplish skills.
Will keep the lesson more interesting for the kids
More practice of skills
Repeated contacts with teacher
Improved focus on the skill being practiced
Higher energy level in class
Improved social skills by group learning to work together

Never sacrifice hands on correction for faster group movement.

Remember you are teaching a group lesson, not a private lesson:
Talk to the whole group
Watch the whole group
Teach to the entire group
Build your queuing skills and keep students moving in patterns
Use corner areas, walls, tot docks to assist moving classes

Moving to the Next Level
If you feel a kid in your group is ready to move up please talk to the Aquatics Coordinators before talking to the parents. We will work together to come up with the best solution for everyone involved.

All swimmers will be tested by the Aquatics Coordinator before moving to another group. Normal days for testing will be on the first day and the 8th day of lessons. If you need someone tested in between these lessons please let us know ahead of time.

Progress Reports & Certificates
On the final day of each session each swimmer will receive a report with specific feedback. Swim Instructors and the Aquatics Coordinators will work together to make these for each swimmer. Progress Report Cards are given to all swimmers staying in their current level for next session. Certificates are awarded to those swimmers who are advancing to the next level.

Private and Semi-Private Lessons Guidelines

- Talk to parents the day of the first lesson; set realistic short term and long term goals for your swimmers. Focus on progress and accomplishments.
- You should be providing constant feedback and correction to your swimmers during their session.
- Always keep your attention focused on your swimmer. Wandering eyes rob energy from the client sending a message of disinterest, downgrade your credibility as an instructor and is noticeable to other members playing in and sitting by the pool – which discredits our entire program.
- Be aware of free-play time – it is important but stay in control and don't let it get out of hand. You should be providing constant instruction. Ask the parent how they feel about playtime at the end of the session; some parents might only want them to swim during their private sessions.
- Have a lesson plan for every session and keep a flexible approach. Focus on progression and technique. Enter each session with an intent to build relationships. Learn more about your clients.
- Sincerely compliment your swimmers early, often and always.
- Make an effort to get your swimmers to laugh and smile during each lesson/workout.
- Wait at least 5 min. before leaving for a no show.

What We Communicate to Families

What to Bring
Goggles, bath towel, a swim cap or ponytail is recommended. We keep the water temperature in our Instructional pool at 84 degrees. This is ideal for swim lessons and in most cases will keep your children comfortable and happy. If your child does get cold we recommend having them wear a rash guard or wet suit.

First Day of Swim Lessons
Please arrive 10 minutes early. It is recommended that children come to the lessons with their swimsuits on. Please let our Front Desk staff know you are here for a swim lesson. One of our Senior Guards will direct you to the whiteboard to introduce swimmers to their instructors. Parents do not need to stay on the pool deck during their lesson but we do need each child to be supervised before and after the lessons.

Family Changing Areas
We have Family Changing rooms, on deck showers and a bathroom all located conveniently in the hallway next to the front desk.

Safety
- For the safety of your child, no one is allowed in the pool before class begins without an instructor. When class is over, all swimmers must exit the pool. Our instructors need to start the next class and therefore cannot supervise the children who are finished with their lesson.
- Please do not bring your child to class if he/she has a fever, runny nose, diarrhea, vomiting, or a rash.

- It is mandatory that all children who are under the age of 3 or who are not fully potty trained wear disposable swim diapers along with reusable swim pants and a swim suit.

Recommendation For Parents

Allow your child to learn in a relaxed, fun, and exciting atmosphere. Children succeed best at their own rate when they do not feel parental pressure.

Policies

Silliman Family Activity and Aquatics Center does not give refunds or provide make-up lessons for any reason.

Attendance and Lesson Coverage

It is vitally important that kids have a consistent instructor. If you are not able to commit to the entire session you will not be scheduled for that session. Our swimmers deserve to have swim instructors who are on time for every lesson. If you get sick during a session and need to find a sub, it is your responsibility. Please contact the Aquatics Coordinator as soon as possible so that he/she can help you.

The job you do for Silliman Family Aquatics To perform it efficiently you must report to work on time and have a good attendance record. Many people depend on you. Your clients want consistency. The lessons are more effective with consistent instructors. Therefore, you must be on the job whenever possible and put your best efforts to work. The following are procedures to follow when you need time off for illness, personal emergency, or vacation.

Any schedule conflicts that arise during lessons must be communicated to the Senior Guard and Aquatic Coordinator immediately. It is the discretion of the Aquatic Coordinator to evaluate these conflicts and make adjustments accordingly.

For illness or personal emergency, all employees must follow these procedures:

1. Immediately call your supervisor and let them know that you are sick and are looking for coverage. If you are unable to directly reach your supervisor, you must contact the Senior Guard to inform them of your situation. It is still YOUR responsibility to find coverage for your lessons.
2. Call everyone on your department phone list to find a sub. See if another swim instructor has breaks within the day to cover some of your lessons.
3. If you cannot find coverage you must come in. If you are truly ill, your supervisor will send you home. It is at the discretion of your supervisor to allow staff to go home if coverage is not found. You must have a communicable infection or serious injury to justify being sent home.

For vacation time off:

It is YOUR responsibility to notify the Senior Guard and Aquatics Coordinator if you are unavailable for the next session. This should be communicated as soon as possible and you are responsible for finding your own coverage for your lesson shifts.

Punctuality:

Frequent absence and/or repeated tardiness or "no shows" will be cause for serious disciplinary action. This action can lead to or include termination.

Uniforms

It is important that you are in uniform to show members you are an instructor.
Uniforms include swim suit and Silliman Center issued rash guard.
Goggles and swim caps are allowed, but please remove them if your student is scared of you in them.

It is extremely important to look professional when teaching lessons out of the water.
No street clothes
No towels draped over your body
No sitting down while teaching or coaching
You must wear proper footwear (slip resistant)

Payroll

Swim Instructors are paid for their set up and clean up time. Please note that if a swim instructor has a gap in their schedule, they have the option to assist another class or do maintenance tasks issued by the Senior Guard. These are the only two items that will justify being paid during the gap. Swim instructors will not receive additional time on their timecards if they decide to spend time in the break room, sit in the spa, etc…

Aquatot Songs

Hello Song
Guess who came to swim today, swim today, swim today
Guess who came to swim today, what's your name?
(child's name) came to swim today, swim today, swim today,
(child's name) came to swim today that's his/her name
(go around in circle and sing for each child in class)

Little Green Frog Song
bubbles went the little green frog one day!
bubbles went the little green frog one day!
bubbles went the little green frog one day!
and his legs went kick-kick-kick

This Is The Way That Dory Looks For Nemo
This is the way that Dory looks for Nemo
This is the way that Dory looks for Nemo
She looks up and down and looks all around
This is the way that Dory looks for Nemo!

Tick-Tock Song
Tick-Tock, Tick Tock, (swaying child back and forth)
I'm a little cuckoo clock
It's two-o'clock (lift child in air two times)

The Kids in the Pool
(tune of "Wheels on the Bus")
The kids in the pool go splash, splash, splash
Splash, splash, splash, splash, splash, splash
The kids in the pool go splash, splash, splash, all day long

The kids in the pool go up and down, up and down
Up and down, up and down
The kids in the pool go up and down, all day long

The kids in the pool go kick, kick, kick …
The kids in the pool go in and out …
The kids in the pool go round and round….
The kids in the pool go swish, swish, swish

If You're Happy And You Know It
If you're happy and you know it splash your hands

If you're happy and you know it splash your hands
If you're happy and you know, then your face will surely show it,
If you're happy and you know it, splash your hands
If you're happy and you know it, kick your feet ...
If you're happy and you know it turn around ...
If you're happy and you know it, blow some bubbles ...
If you're happy and you know it, jump up and down ...
If you're happy and you know it, clap your hands ...

London Bridge (with big mat as a bridge)
London Bridge is falling down, falling down, falling down
London Bridge is falling down, my fair lady (repeat)
Take the key and lock her up, lock her up, lock her up
Take the key and lock her up, my fair lady

All Around the Mulberry Bush
All around the mulberry bush the monkey chased the weasel
The monkey thought it would be all in good fun
POP goes the weasel!

Hokey Pokey
You put your right arm in, you put your right arm out
You put your right arm in, and you shake it all about
You do the hokey pokey and you turn yourself around
That's what it's all about!
(Repeat using: left arm, right leg, left leg, whole self)

We're Going For A Swim
(to the tune of Farmer in the Dell)
We're going for a swim, we're going for a swim
Hi ho and away we go, we're going for a swim
(Repeat with going to do a bob, going to blow bubbles)

Motorboat
Motorboat, motorboat go so slow
Motorboat, motorboat go so medium
Motorboat, motorboat go so fast
Motorboat, motorboat step on the gas!

Ring around the Rosie
Ring around the rosie, pocket full of posies
Splashes, splashes, we all fall down!
(Repeat with we all blow bubbles, we all splash our hands, we all kick our feet)

I'm a Little Turtle
(tune of "I'm A Little Teapot")
(great for practicing back floats)
I'm a little turtle on my back
I'm a little turtle nice and flat
I'm a little turtle on my back
Just flip me over, and swim me back!

Twinkle, Twinkle Little Star
Twinkle, twinkle, little star
How I wonder what you are
Up above the world so high
Like a diamond in the sky
Twinkle, twinkle, little star
How I wonder what you are

Row, Row, Row Your Boat
Row, row, row your boat
Gently down the stream
Merrily, merrily, life is but a dream

Humpty Dumpty Sat On The Wall
Humpty dumpty sat on the wall
Humpty dumpty had a great fall! (kids sit on pool edge and fall in)

Itsy Bitsy Spider
The itsy bitsy spider went up the water spout
Down came the rain and washed the spider out
Up came the sun and dried up all the rain
And the itsy bitsy spider went up the spout again!

Bye Bye Song
Tiny tots, it's time to go, time to go, time to go
Tiny tots it's time to go
Bye bye (child's name)
(Repeat with each child's name and wave good bye on their turn)

Old McDonald Had A Pond
Old McDonald had a pond
E-I-E-I-O!
And in this pond he had a [fish, duck, frog, turtle]
E-I-E-I-O!
With a [action]x2 here
And a [action] x2 there
Here a [action]
There a [action]
Everywhere a [action] x2
Old McDonald had a pond
E-I-E-I-O!

Sample Aquatot Games

Piggyback Ride
Description: Parents back up against the side of the pool. Children get on their parents' backs, putting their arms loosely around their parents' necks. Parents travel across the pool, squatting down, bending their knees until shoulders are at the level of the water and keeping their backs straight while children kick their feet.

Motorboat
Description: Form a large circle. Parents hold children in a front float position on the outside of the circle. Have children start the engine by blowing bubbles. Instructor gives directions to have them speed up (blow bubbles fast), slow down (blow bubbles slowly) and put on the brakes (parents help children lean back into a back float position).
Adaptation: Parents tow children by their hands or support them under the arms.

"Pop Goes the Weasel"
Description: Form a circle. Parent holds the child. Traveling to the right or left, sing the song "Pop Goes the Weasel." At the last line of each verse, the parent raises the child up in the air and lowers him or her back into the water to the shoulders.
Safety Note: Do not let the parent throw the child in the air.
Simon Says
Description: Tell the class that you are going to say and do skills, such as kicking, arm strokes and blowing bubbles. Explain that if you say the words, "Simon Says," they should do the skills that you say and do. Explain that if they do not

hear the words, "Simon Says," they should not move.

Follow the Leader
Description: Instructor is the first leader and does a skill that everyone imitates, such as jumping, blowing bubbles or kicking. Children take turns being leader. If children can stand, parents remain beside or behind the child and do the skills along with the child. If children cannot stand, parents hold their children.

Retrieve the Toys
Description: Starting at one side of the pool, children retrieve balls or corks floating on the other side of the pool. If children can stand, parents remain within arm's reach of their children. If children cannot stand, parents hold their children. Use rubber ducks and go duck hunting. Use floating fish (squirt fish) and go fishing.

Chop Chop Timber
Description: Children sit on the edge and parents water them. They grow into trees with big branches and then the lumberjack comes to chop them down.

Baby Dolphin
Description: Instructor places the "baby" through a hoop into the outstretched hands of the parent.

Washing Machine
Description: Parents pretend to put soap on their child's hair and scrub it clean. To rinse the soap off, direct the children to tip their heads to the right side, then to the left side; tip the head back; put the head partially under; and then submerge the head completely.

Red Light-Green Light
Description: Have children perform a certain skill, such as blowing bubbles, kicking or arm stroking. Ask them to start the skill on the command "green light." Tell them to stop the skill on the command "red light." Ask them to perform different skills, alternately starting and stopping them on your green light and red light commands.

Flip Flop
Description: Children are on the side of the pool. On the instructor's signal, have them jump in, level off and begin swimming on their fronts. When the instructor says "flip," children turn over and swim on their backs. When the instructor says "flop," they roll onto their fronts again and continue to swim. Parents assist or support children as needed. As children become more confident and skilled, parents reduce assistance until it is no longer necessary.

What Time Is It, Mr. Sharky?
Description: Have parents line up in a line. Have the children and parents ask: "What time is it Mr. Sharky?" The instructor will then say "five-o-clock" (or any other number) and the children will do five arm strokes or kicks forward. Have the parents repeat this until it's "Lunch time" where the Shark will then tag the child or parent who will then become the shark.

Sample Preschool Games

Red Light-Green Light
Description: Have children perform a certain skill, such as blowing bubbles, kicking or arm stroking. Ask them to start the skill on the command "green light." Tell them to stop the skill on the command "red light." Ask them to perform different skills, alternately starting and stopping them on your green light and red light commands.

Blowing Bubbles with Imagination
Purpose: To help participants with blowing bubbles, rhythmic breathing and bobbing
Description: Have swimmers imagine doing the following to encourage them to blow bubbles, at the surface of the water or while submerged:
• Blow out a candle
• Blow away a dandelion
• Make a tugboat motor noise
• Hum underwater and hum the ABCs
• Play an instrument that you have to blow into, such as a trumpet, saxophone, etc…
• Blow a bubble with bubble gum
• Blow a watermelon seed
• Blow like the wind
• Blow crumbs off the table
• Blow the ladybug off your hand
• Blow like Superman to send the bad guys away

Simon Says
Description: Tell the class that you are going to say and do skills, such as kicking, arm strokes and blowing bubbles. Explain that if you say the words, "Simon Says," they should do the skills that you say and do. Explain that if they do not hear the words, "Simon Says," they should not move.

Flip Flop
Description: Children are on the side of the pool. On the instructor's signal, have them jump in, level off and begin swimming on their fronts. When the instructor says "flip," children turn over and swim on their backs. When the instructor says "flop," they roll onto their fronts again and continue to swim. Help support the children as needed. As children become more confident and skilled, instructor can assistance until it is no longer necessary.

What Time Is It, Mr. Sharky?
Description: Have your class start at the wall. You can have one "helper" (who will be Mr. Sharky). Have the rest of the clas ask: "What time is it Mr. Sharky?" The "helper" will then say a time example: "five-o-clock" (or any other number). The class will then do five arm strokes forward. The class will repeat this until it's "Lunch time" where the "helper"/Mr. Sharky will try to tag someone in the class. Whoever is tagged is the next Mr. Sharky/"helper".

Finding Fish
Purpose: To practice side breathing
Description: Have swimmers line up along the wall; if participants can stand in the water, have them form a circle. Have participants "listen to the fish" by having them put their heads in the water so one ear is in the water and their faces are to the side.Have swimmers "talk to the fish" by having them turn their heads so their faces are toward the bottom and blow bubbles. When your class is more advanced, they can practice looking and listening to the fish while kicking on the wall.

Silliman Swim School Report Cards

Preschool Level: 1

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Staying Safe Around Water
- ☐ How to recognize a lifeguard
- ☐ Wearing a lifejacket
- ☐ Recognize an emergency
- ☐ How to call for help
- ☐ Too much sun is no fun

☐ Move on to Level 2

☐ Please repeat Level 1

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Full head submersion 2-5 times.
- Front float with whole face in the water w/instructor support.
- Back float with ears submerged w/instructor support.
- Remains comfortable throughout the session.
- Arm circles and kicks with help.
- Pick up object with full head submersion.

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Preschool Level: 2

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ How to call for help
- ☐ How recognize a lifeguard
- ☐ Wearing a lifejacket
- ☐ Staying safe around water
- ☐ Recognize an emergency
- ☐ Too much sun for fun

☐ Move on to Level 3

☐ Please repeat Level 2

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Glides Front and Back with recovery with little or no support.
- Floats: front and back, unsupported
- Combined arm/leg action on front and back.
- Kicks on back, unsupported.
- Treading water 10 seconds

* Must have mastered prior level 1 skills beyond these requirements.

Proficiency and skills: This is a list of basic requirements. Students must have a specific mastery of the skill and proficiency before moving to the next level as well as meet all exit skill requirements. Proficiency is determined by staff.

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Preschool Level: 3

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Think Before You Sink.
- ☐ Swim while wearing a lifejacket
- ☐ Look before you leap.
- ☐ How to recognize a swimmer in distress and get help.
- ☐ Tread water.
- ☐ Reach Or Throw, Don't Go

☐ Move on to Youth*

Please speak with the Aquatics Coordinator prior to Registration! Registration will be blocked.

☐ Please repeat Level 3

Requirements to pass this level:

- Freestyle with side breathing, breathe at least 5 times consistently.
- Backstroke: 4 body lengths.
- Elementary Backstroke
- Streamline Glide 2 body lengths.
- Roll from front to back.

*** Must have mastered all level 2 requirements prior to these skills.**

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Youth Level: 1

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Staying Safe Around Water
- ☐ Be Cool Follow The Pool Rules
- ☐ How to Call For Help
- ☐ Wearing A Life Jacket
- ☐ Recognize a Emergency
- ☐ Recognizing A Lifeguard
- ☐ Too Much Sun Is No Fun

☐ Move on to Level 2

☐ Please repeat Level 1

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Bubbles with Full head submersion 5 times.
- Front float with whole face in the water w/ instructor support for 2 body lengths.
- Back float with ears submerged w/ instructor support for 5 seconds.
- Remains comfortable throughout the session.
- Alternating arm/leg action on front/back for 2 body lengths.
- Pick up object with eyes open full head submersion.

Proficiency and skills: This is a list of basic requirements. Students must have a specific mastery of the skill and proficiency before moving to the next level as well as meet all exit skill requirements. Proficiency is determined by staff.

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Youth Level: 2

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Swim while wearing a life jacket
- ☐ Look before you leap
- ☐ How to recognize a distressed swim and get help
- ☐ Reach or throw, don't go
- ☐ The danger of drains

☐ Move on to Level 3

☐ Please repeat Level 2

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Floats/Glides: Front and back

  Unsupported with recovery.
- Combined stroke arm circles and kicks, independently for 3 body lengths.
- Combined stroke on back, independently + 5 body lengths.
- Treading water 15 seconds.
- * Must have mastered prior level 1 skills beyond these requirements.

Proficiency and skills: This is a list of basic requirements. Students must have a specific mastery of the skill and proficiency before moving to the next level as well as meet all exit skill requirements. Proficiency is determined by staff.

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Youth Level: 3

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Think Twice Before going Near Cold Water or Ice
- ☐ Reach or Throw
- ☐ Developing breath control safely
- ☐ Making good decisions

☐ Move on to Level 4

☐ Please repeat Level 3

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Freestyle with side breathing, breathe at least 10x consistently.
- Backstroke: 4 body lengths.
- Treading water for 60 seconds.
- Dolphin kick: 3-5 body lengths
- Elementary Backstroke: 5 body lengths.
- Breast stroke kick: 5 body lengths.

*** Must have mastered all level 2 requirements prior to these skills.**

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Youth Level: 4

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Reaching Assist
- ☐ Throwing Assist
- ☐ Think So You Don't Sink
- ☐ Look Before You Leap

☐ Move on to Level 5

☐ Please repeat Level 4

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Freestyle 25 yards w/ open turn.
- Backstroke 15 yards w/ open turn.
- Butterfly 15 yards.
- Sidestroke 15 yards.
- Breaststroke 15 yards.
- Elementary Backstroke 25 yards.
- Tread water for 2 minutes.
- *** Must have mastered all level 3 requirements prior to these skills.**

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.

Youth Level: 5

Water Safety Topics:

- ☐ Importance of knowing First Aid & CPR
- ☐ Recreational Water Illnesses
- ☐ Wave, Tide or Ride, Follow the Guide

☐ Move on to Comp Swim!

* Requires additional registration

☐ Please repeat Level 5

Practice Makes Perfect!

Requirements to pass this level:

- Freestyle 50 yards w/ flip turn.
- Backstroke 50 yards w/ flip turn.
- Butterfly 25 yards.
- Sidestroke 25 yards.
- Breaststroke 25 yards.
- Elementary Backstroke 25 yards.
- Tread water for 5 minutes.
- *** Must have mastered all level 4 requirements prior to these skills.**

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS/SKILLS STUDENT NEEDS TO IMPROVE:

Please note every child progresses differently.

We reserve the right to move your child from the class you signed up for to one that is more developmentally appropriate.